

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠Q

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 5♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣2

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠10

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥8

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 4
 ♥ 8 3
 ♦ K J 10 7 2
 ♣ 7 6 2

♠ K 5 3

♥ A 10 9 5 2

♦ A 9 4

♣ A 4



♠ Q J 10 9

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 8 5 3

♣ 8 5 3

♠ A 6 2

♥ K Q J 7

♦ 6

♣ K Q J 10 9

When SOUTH answers Blackwood with one Ace
 NORTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, SOUTH would bid 6♥. But she
 knows that if she does so, NORTH might stop right
 there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces,
 SOUTH figures her ♣ suit will supply five tricks so
 she bids 7♥.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	5NT	Pass	7♥
All Pass			
7♥ by North			
Lead: ♠Q			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ Q 9 7 4
 ♦ K Q 5
 ♣ A 10 8 3

♠ J 10 6 2

♥ 10 8

♦ A 7 4 3

♣ 7 5 4



♠ A K Q 5

♥ A J 6 5 2

♦ 6

♣ K Q J

♠ 9 4 3

♥ K 3

♦ J 10 9 8 2

♣ 9 6 2

EAST thinks there might be slam if WEST holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When WEST shows just one Ace EAST is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so he stops at 5♥.

It turns out that EAST might make twelve tricks, depending on the ♥K situation.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♦	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			
5♥ by East			
Lead: ♣2			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 9 8

♥ 10 9

♦ J 8 7 4

♣ J 6 5

♠ K 4 2

♥ A Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ K

♣ K 3



♠ 7 5 3

♥ 6 3

♦ 10 9 5 3

♣ Q 10 8 2

♠ A J 6

♥ K 5

♦ A Q 6 2

♣ A 9 7 4

NORTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam in ♥s. He chooses to temporize with a 1♥ response and is rewarded when SOUTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents NORTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine. When he discovers that SOUTH holds three Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♠10			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 6 3
 ♥ A 10 7
 ♦ 9 5 2
 ♣ A 10 8 6

♠ J 9 4

♥ 9 8 5 3 2

♦ A 8 7

♣ 9 2



♠ A K
 ♥ K Q 4
 ♦ K Q J 3
 ♣ K Q J 5

♠ 10 8 7 5 2

♥ J 6

♦ 10 6 4

♣ 7 4 3

WEST responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

EAST only needs to know how many Aces are in the WEST hand. He must use Gerber since 4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When WEST shows two Aces EAST bids 6NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♠	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			
6NT by West			
Lead: ♥8			